

Mitigation report

DAY 10 — BAITING & WATERING HOLE MITIGATION REPORT

The objectives of this task were to identify security controls that can reduce the risks associated with baiting and watering hole attacks.

1. Web Filtering

- Organisations should use web filtering to restrict access to known malicious, suspicious, or inappropriate websites.
- This can reduce the chance of users visiting compromised websites or malicious download pages.

2. Script Blocking

- Unnecessary or suspicious browser scripts should be restricted where possible.
- Browser security controls and script-blocking technologies can help reduce the risk of malicious content executing in a user's browser.

3. Patch Management

- Operating systems, browsers, applications, and security software should be regularly updated.
- Security updates help protect systems against vulnerabilities that attackers may attempt to exploit.

4. User Awareness

- Employees should be trained to recognise suspicious downloads, unexpected links, fake software updates, and websites that request unusual permissions or information.
- Users should avoid downloading files from untrusted websites and should report suspicious links or websites to the IT/security team.

5. Endpoint Security

- Endpoint security and antivirus/EDR solutions should be used to detect suspicious files, processes, and other potentially malicious activity.

6. Access Controls

- Users should operate with only the permissions necessary for their work.
- Limiting unnecessary privileges can reduce the potential impact of a successful attack.

7. Honeypot Monitoring

- Security teams can use honeypots and other monitoring systems in controlled environments to identify suspicious activity and study attack behaviour.

Side Note: The exercise was performed entirely on a localhost as a controlled cybersecurity simulation. The honeypot recorded tests requests from the local computer and did not target or monitor external users.